



Football frenzy unleashed

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Cometh the World Cup, cometh the game. In EA's and FIFA's grand master plan of promoting the ultimate brand of football to fans all over the world, this game's a true ambassador to the cause. If you're going through World Cup withdrawal, there's no better fix than playing this virtual football simulation, a game that transports you back to Brazil in all its frenzy. Doesn't matter if Germany's already won the Cup, because there's no such thing as too many replays, right? And what if you disagreed with how it all went down? It's time to set the record straight.

First things first: EA's FIFA World Cup 2014 is neither FIFA 14, nor is it FIFA 15. If you're familiar with previous FIFA World Cup gaming titles, this one, too, is a one-off spectacle that builds on the experience of its immediate predecessor without changing too many things, and certainly giving no hints of what's to come in the next installment of the franchise. In terms of graphics, this game looks the same as FIFA 14, with the added bonus of new intro, in-game animations, focusing on the theatrical aspects of the game more



than the actual gameplay. Having watched the sights and scenes of the World Cup games on the telly, this game does a great job of recapturing the atmosphere we experienced in all of these games.

The game has a nice game mode in Captain Your Country (a la FIFA's Career Mode), where you have to guide your team to the finals. Another interesting mode called Story of Qualifying transports you to real-life qualifying scenarios, making for some exciting matches that help you get familiarized with most of the good teams in the tournament. Road to the FIFA World Cup gives you access to all 203 officially recognised FIFA national teams and you can rewrite history by guiding a minnow (which didn't qualify for the finals) all the way to the crown. All these features are nice to explore, giving you much-needed World Cup lore to look back upon.

As for the gaming engine itself, we liked the subtle refinements made to taking penalty kicks and corners, where you can add more pressure on the keeper and customize team orders and tactics in greater detail. Thanks to subtle improvements to FIFA's Impact Engine, the speed and pace of this game seems to have been tightened ever so slightly to make it a nice experience, overall, and this game is definitely something that you need to play with friends or family who want to be in on the World Cup extravaganza.

Verdict

But at ₹3.5k, this is an expensive interactive entertainment option, one that's worth skipping if you aren't deeply invested in EA's FIFA franchise. But for everyone else, fans of the game and the virtual EA franchise, this is a great way to keep replaying the World Cup on your screens, on weekends, until the start of the new European football season or till the launch of FIFA 15. Nothing more, nothing less. *



MOAR!

Developer: EA Canada

Publisher: EA Sports

Platform: PlayStation 3, Xbox 360

Price: ₹3,499